Burners Referee Magic Items

Referee only. Who an enchanted armament **accepts**, and what that means, is in [[Burners Adventure Game#Enchanted Arms and Armor]]. This page is how you stock it, convert it, and run it.

Enchanted = legendary = eldritch = magic. Same class. A *+1 sword* is a freaking magic sword — woke steel that may talk, burn, or hunt. The plus only sets how many minor powers you stock, not how trivial the find is.

In combat, an enchanted arm or armor the wielder's Trait has **accepted** gives **one extra die** when that item is the thing in play (Initiative, a blow, or Defend / Block with a shield). Out of combat they give no extra dice. **Powers** also require that acceptance (and that the power has been found). Without the Trait the piece is mundane kit in their hands. A module **+n** means **n minor powers**, not a bigger number on the roll.

Quality above fine steel

Mundane quality — **Common**, **Fine steel**, **Signature** — lives in [[Burners Arms and Armor]]. These rungs are magical (or magic-adjacent) and live only here:

Tuned

Fitted to one grip and dialed in. A **Tuned** weapon **counts as enchanted** for that grip (accepted only with the Trait; extra die and powers once found) and is **Trusty** (never sticks or notches). A tuning belongs to one hand: a blade tuned to a dead man's grip must be **re-tuned** before it answers you (a master's fee, or your own Craft 1+, tools, coin, and downtime). Earned in play, never at creation.

Bane-forged

Made for one enemy. Against its named quarry it *is* the **right tool** — no fiction claim needed; the wielder may burn the extra Fuel into every on-quarry blow. This is where module *"+1, +3 vs. dragons"* goes — as a power on enchanted steel, not a bigger number.

Legendary / named relics

Found, never made. A relic may lie dormant as ordinary gear until you discover its true name — read from a tomb-glyph, **surrendered by an Invocation** to the patron it serves, or earned by the deed it was made for. The name costs no XP. With the matching Trait you are accepted (extra die and powers once found).

Named relics and true names matter for fiction and for waking a dormant piece; they do not make a second mechanical tier above "enchanted." Enchanted, legendary, and eldritch are one class.

About one in six relics speaks. These are **Sentient Items**, each a bound soul with its own will and powers that can aid, argue, or betray you. Many more were once sentient but broke over the long ages, most of them mad and silent. A mute relic in your hands is not safely empty; it may be inert, or a madness too far gone for words. Sentience is a **layer on enchanted kit**, not a milder find — the Trait still gates acceptance; ego and speech sit on top (no Oracle roll to "accept"; the Trait is the gate, as with any enchanted arm).

+n → powers

When a module lists a *+1 sword*, *+2 shield*, *+1 plate*, and so on — convert in two parts. Keep Slots, AC, and size as the mundane piece would be.

1. Enchanted. The item is enchanted — a magic sword (or shield, or harness), full stop. Acceptance wants the fitting Trait; without it the enchantment is quiet (see [[Burners Adventure Game#Enchanted Arms and Armor]]).

2. Special powers — one per plus. A +1 item has one +1-tier power. A +2 adds a second, +2-tier power. A +3 adds a third, and so on. Powers are minor — convenience, flavor, situational edges — not extra dice on every blow.

Tier	Scope
+1	Passive or **once per fight** — sensory tricks, light, faint Bane hints
+2	**Once per session** or a stronger passive — named sword powers (flaming, charm, locate), stronger Bane
+3+	**Once per delve**, or once in the campaign for the rarest edges — not wishes or energy drain

Record them like Trait Signatures: each power you have **found** earns an asterisk on the item line and a footnote. Until you find a power, leave the star off; the Referee knows what is waiting.

On your sheet	Meaning
`arming sword` (enchanted)	Magic steel; silent until you hold *arming sword* (or the fitting Trait) — then extra die and powers as found
`arming sword*`	Accepted; one +1-tier power discovered — footnote * names it
`arming sword**`	A +2 item; both powers found — footnotes * and **

No plusses on sums. A +n from another game never becomes a bonus added to a roll total. It becomes **enchanted** arms or armor: acceptance by Trait, the extra die, plus n minor powers once found.

Disarming an enchanted weapon denies its magic while it is out of hand.

Shields and armor use the same ladder: a +2 heater is enchanted plus a +1-tier power and a +2-tier power; +1 chain is enchanted plus one +1-tier power. Do not raise AC or size for the plus — the powers carry the rest.

OSE conversion (magic arms)

Potions, rings, cursed items, and wondrous items port as written in [[Burners OSE Conversions]]. **Magic arms, shields, and armor** convert only by this page.

OSE treasure swords (SRD: Swords) layer three kinds of bonus:

1. **The plus** — attack and damage bonus → Burners **enchanted** (no to-hit).

2. **Bane vs type** — *"+2 vs lycanthropes"*, *"+3 vs undead"* → a +1-tier or +2-tier power that **is the right tool** (or reads as silver) vs that quarry — not a bigger number.
3. **Named power** — *flaming*, *light*, *locate objects*, *charm person*, *energy drain*, *wishes* → assign to **+1 / +2 / +3** tiers by potency (below).

Sentient swords (30% of magic swords; SRD: Sentient Swords) are a **layer on enchanted kit**, not a smaller find: roll INT, Ego, alignment, sensory and extraordinary powers, optional special purpose. Use that procedure when the module implies personality, control checks, or speech — and remember every *+1 longsword* is already magic steel that might one day speak. Convert **enchanted + powers** first (Trait acceptance); add INT/Ego and the sensory/extraordinary tables on top. There is no separate Oracle roll for acceptance — the kit Trait is the gate.

OSE **armor and shields** in treasure are usually plain **+n** with no second power (Treasures: Armour and Shields). Invent **+1 / +2** powers from the suggestions below, or steal a sensory or protection theme from rings and cloaks in the same book.

Suggested powers by tier

Pick one per tier, or roll **d12** on the column. Re-roll duplicates. Route OSE text directly when the module names the power (*Sword +1, Flaming* → take the **+1-tier** fire row and the **+2-tier** anti-troll/plant row as ∗ and ∗∗).

Weapons — +1-tier *(OSE sensory / faint Bane)*

d12	Power	OSE root
1	**Bane-hint** — hums or chills within 20' of the named quarry (undead, lycanthropes, dragons, spellcasters, enchanted things); is only a hint until the **+2** power is found (then it is the right tool)	*+2/+3 vs type*
2	**Silver-edge** — counts as **silver** (right tool vs silver-weak foes) once per fight	*vs lycanthropes*
3	**Detect magic** — on command, magic within 20' may be made to glow; 3×/day	*sensory: detect magic*
4	**Detect trap** — sense traps within 10'; 3×/day	*sensory: detect traps*
5	**Secret door** — find secret doors within 10'; 3×/day	*sensory: locate secret doors*
6	**Light** — 30' light on command	*Sword +1, Light*
7	**Never notches** — **Trusty**; will not stick or fail	*fine steel*
8	**See invisible** — see invisible within 20' while drawn	*sensory: see invisible*
9	**Detect metal** — points to a named metal within 60' (lead blocks)	*sensory: detect metals*
10	**Slope-sense** — feel sloped floors within 10'	*sensory: detect slopes*
11		*sensory: detect gems*

d12	Power	OSE root
	Gem-sense — points toward gems within 60’; counts them (lead blocks)	
12	**Alignment tingle** — sense hostile intent within 20’ (not traps or beasts)	*sensory: detect evil/good*

Weapons — +2-tier *(OSE named sword powers / stronger Bane)*

d12	Power	OSE root
1	**Bane-forged** — **right tool** vs the named quarry, no claim needed (undead, dragons, regenerating foes, enchanted creatures, spellcasters)	*+3 vs type*
2	**Flaming** — blade ignites on command; once per session, +1 effective blow die vs trolls, plant-things, or undead while lit	*Sword +1, Flaming*
3	**Locate object** — once per day, sense one named object-type within 120’	*Sword +1, Locate Objects*
4	**Charm** — once per week, a **Control** working (Heart vs Heart) on one touched foe — it lands or it doesn’t, and it is not puppetry	*Sword +2, Charm Person*
5	**Bind on Spark** — once per session, when a blow **Sparks**, **bind** the foe’s weapon without a maneuver	*Binding tag*
6	**Healing edge** — once per day, while held, heal 1 HP per round for 6 rounds (combat counts)	*extraordinary: healing, toned down*
7	**Feint ward** — once per fight, once per fight, open one closed Hit vs mundane white only (shell/plate still closed)	*extra damage, toned down*
8	**Missile ward** — once per session, **Cover** or **Defend** softens a breath or area effect you could not fully ward (half the overrun)	*shield crossover*
9	**Purging blow** — once per session, shed one **lingering Cost** on yourself (poison, chill, fear) when you draw blood	*paladin-flavor*
10	**Shifting sense** — locate shifting walls or rooms within 10’	*sensory: shifting architecture*
11	**Telekinetic tug** — once per session, **Man-handle** at range to trip or shove without a Spark; Fuel it with one die	*extraordinary: telekinesis, toned down*

d12	Power	OSE root
12	**Purpose sting** — vs the sword's designated quarry, when a blow **Sparks** the foe must **Defend** or suffer a brief **Control** (into the dirt, drop weapon, or flee — Referee picks)	*special purpose alignment power, toned down*

Weapons — +3-tier *(OSE extraordinary / special purpose — still not a relic)*

d12	Power	OSE root
1	**Deep Bane** — **right tool** vs quarry; once per delve, a killing blow on-quarry cannot be shrugged off (no instant death — empties the pile / drives a Burner to **0 HP** and holds)	*special purpose*
2	**Draining nick** — once per delve, when a blow **Sparks** on a living foe, cost them **1 HP from their maximum** until cured by rest (not OSE level drain)	*energy drain, heavily toned down*
3	**Spark on 5** — once per delve, treat a rolled **5** as a **Spark**	*extra damage, one shot*
4	**Ward spell** — once per delve, fully **Defend** one hostile spell (compare totals)	*protection from magic*
5	**Clairvoyant strike** — once per delve, before one blow, the Referee answers one yes/no about the target's guard or intent	*clairvoyance, toned down*
6	**X-ray sweep** — once per delve, one 10' square searched: secret doors and traps revealed	*x-ray vision search*
7	**Levitation grip** — once per delve, ignore a fall or cross a gap on the blade's will	*levitation, toned down*
8	**Illusion veil** — once per delve, throw a brief **phantasm** (distraction, not damage)	*illusion*
9	**Teleport step** — once per delve, blink 30' you can see	*teleportation, heavily toned down*
10	**Neutral blessing** — while drawn, **+1** to all hazard **Defends** for the scene (once per delve)	*neutral special purpose*
11	**Paralyzing sting** — once per delve vs quarry, blow **Sparks → Defend** or **Control** into the dirt / stiffen 2d6 rounds	*lawful special purpose, toned down*
12	**Petrifying sting** — once per delve vs lawful quarry, blow **Sparks → Defend** or **Control**	*chaotic special purpose, heavily toned down*

d12	Power	OSE root
	(stone-slow: half move, Defend at one die only) 1 round	

Shields — +1-tier

d12	Power
1	Boss never splinters on a burned **1**
2	Faint **silver** gleam when undead or lycanthropes near
3	Warn with a chill when a missile is aimed at you (once/fight, +1 die on **Cover** or **Defend** vs that shot)
4	Shed mud, ice, or blood instantly — never slippery
5	**Detect magic** 3×/day within 20’ while raised
6	Mirror-bright; reflects gaze attacks once/fight at a **Defend**
7	Holy water etched inside — once/session, fire as the right tool vs undead (see [[Burners Burn Undead]])
8	Arrow notch — first arrow each fight **Defended** as if one extra die burned
9	Rally flash — ally in front facing gains +1 on next **Morale** check
10	Boss rings when struck by magic
11	Never heavy — counts as one slot less for encumbrance fiction only
12	**Light** on command in a 10’ radius

Shields — +2-tier

d12	Power
1	**Block** once/session: redirect a blow onto yourself without spending an attack
2	**Cover** softens a breath or area effect at half the overrun
3	**Bane-rim** — **right tool** for one Block or Defend vs the named quarry
4	Once/session, **bind** an attacker’s weapon when you **Block** or Defend cleanly
5	Once/session, **Man-handle** shove without a Spark; Fuel it with one die (foe your size or less)
6	Catch missile — one ranged hit per session cut to 0 before armor
7	**Ward** — first hostile spell each delve at you is **Defended** with +1 die
8	**Phalanx** — while braced, allies in facing may treat you as **Cover**
9	Shed **lingering Cost** once/session when you take a blow on the shield

d12	Power
10	**Purify** — holy water splash from the boss once/day
11	**Missile magnet** — archers in front facing suffer −1 effective blow die once/fight
12	**Second cover** — one ally per session may **Defend** using your shield die

Armor — +1-tier

d12	Power
1	Comfortable as cloth — no **fatigue** tick from the harness alone
2	**Fire-kind** — resist mundane fire; first burn each fight −1 overrun
3	**Cold-kind** — first cold/chill **Cost** each delve halved
4	Quiet — no penalty to stealth from armor noise
5	**Detect evil/good** within 10’ while worn
6	**Gemsense** — wearer knows if gems within 30’ (lead blocks)
7	**Silvered** — one location (gauntlets, gorget) counts as silver (right tool vs silver-weak)
8	**Called-shot gap** closed for **head** or **hands** (pick at identification)
9	Harness never traps you — free escape from grapple once/fight
10	**Light** — breastplate or helm glows 10’ on command
11	**Trusty** — straps and buckles never fail
12	**Bane-stitch** — hums near the named quarry

Armor — +2-tier

d12	Power
1	**Bane-mail** — **right tool** for one blow per session vs quarry
2	**Ward** — first hostile spell each delve: **Defend** with +1 die
3	**Soak trick** — once/session, treat AC as **+1** vs one blow
4	**Close the gap** — once/delve, ignore one **called shot** to an uncovered location
5	**Shed Cost** — lose one **lingering Cost** when you reach **full HP**
6	**Shock cushion** — once/session, **Shock Check** at **+1**
7	**Fire ward** — mundane fire does not linger on the harness
8	

d12	Power
	Missile turn — first missile each session **Defended** as +1 die
9	**Heroic stand** — at **0 HP**, stay standing one round once/delve (then Shock as normal)
10	**Anti-magic weave** — **soak 1** vs hostile magic where covered (Burner AC-like)
11	**Regenerating foe** — once/session, cancel one "heals next round" on a foe you wounded
12	**Purpose guard** — vs quarry, first Wound each delve reduced by 1 HP depth

Module text cheat sheet

OSE says	Burners
Sword +1	Enchanted only, or enchanted + roll **+1-tier**
Sword +1, +3 vs Undead	Enchanted · ∗ Bane-hint undead · ∗∗ Bane-forged vs undead
Sword +1, Flaming	Enchanted · ∗ Light or fire-hint · ∗∗ Flaming
Sword +2	Enchanted · ∗ + ∗∗ (two rolls)
Sword +2, Charm Person	Enchanted · ∗ (roll) · ∗∗ Charm
Sword +3	Enchanted · three tiers (roll or design) — consider 2d6 relic
Shield/Armour +n	Enchanted · powers per **n** (shields/armor tables)

Sheet example — +2 arming sword, both powers found:

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arming sword** (2 slots, enchanted)
*  Hums near oath-breakers; reads as silver (right tool vs silver-weak, once/fight).
** Once per session, when a blow Sparks, bind the foe's weapon — no maneuver.
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Worked example — +2 longsword in a chest: enchanted arming sword. Referee's margin: +1 power = hums near oath-breakers / silver-edge; +2 power = bind on Spark once per session. On the player's sheet after both are found: `arming sword**` with footnotes ∗ and ∗∗ as above.

Named & strange steel (2d6)

Use **enchanted + powers** for anonymous module loot (*"+1 sword"*). Roll **2d6** when the text names the item, sets a special purpose (*"+2, +3 vs dragons"*), or reads like a relic — then layer **powers** from the +n on top of whatever rung the table gives. The further from 7, the stranger the steel beneath the enchantment:

2d6	The blade is…
2	**A relic all along.** Enchanted; dormant until its true name is learned.
3	**Bane-forged** against a foe fitting the module (the Referee names the quarry).
4	**An unusual tag** for its type — Control, Binding, Handguard, or Stabbity where its kind carries none.
5	**Tuned** — to a dead hand. Re-tune to wake it.

2d6	The blade is…
6	**Signature** — a name, a history, a hook. Fine steel beneath.
7	**Fine steel, plain and true** — Trusty, and it sells dear.
8	**Signature.**
9	**Tuned** — to a dead hand.
10	**An unusual tag** for its type.
11	**Bane-forged.**
12	**A relic all along.**

A **+3 or better** weapon in the text is the module telling you to skip the table: ask whether this one is a relic.

Rarity valve: convert only the *interesting* magic arms upward on the ladder. The anonymous **+1 longsword** in a chest is **enchanted + one +1-tier power** — no 2d6 roll required.

Mundane fine make on armor becomes a **fitted Signature harness** — comfortable, quiet, worth coin, never hinders. **+n armor or shields** never raise AC or size for the plus.